

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Eighth Month, 2026



Monthly Query: *How do I demonstrate in my own decision making a concern for ecological, economic and social justice?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *Your silent prayer and openness to Spirit are themselves a form of ministry that enriches the Meeting community.*

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Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom - After meeting - Potluck in the schoolhouse
Second Sunday	8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom
Third Sunday	8:00 - 9:00 am - Early worship in the meeting room (reverts to 8:15 the following week) 9:00 - 10:30 am - Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom
Fourth Sunday	Same as Second Sunday - Blended Meeting
Fifth Sunday	Same as First Sunday, but without potluck



Upcoming Zoom Fora

<https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html>

August 2: Summer sharing forum on “Divine”

August 9: Summer sharing forum on “Quaker”

August 16: Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business - No forum

August 23: TBD

August 30: TBD



Upcoming Events

“Dance Meditations” at Durham Friends, 2 Saturdays/month 4-6 pm

This is Jack Wolf from Eno Friends in Hillsborough.

We have been doing a series of "Dance Meditations" at Durham Friends in the Fellowship Hall on various Saturday afternoons. Richard Jerram, another Eno Quaker, Laura Aliberti, and myself are weaving the dance sets. These are similar to what is called Ecstatic Dance Waves locally.

Our next dance is Saturday August 1, 4-6 PM, and I will be doing the set. Laura will be doing it for Aug 29 and Richard Sept 12. All our upcoming dates are: Aug 1, 29. Sep 12, 26, Oct 3, 31 Nov 14, 28. We have a Facebook Group where we would post any further info or changes at [\(1\) Dance Meditations | Facebook](#)

No fee, but we will accept donations only to cover the rent. We all volunteer. We gather at 4 PM, have an opening circle at 4:10. Dance from 4:15 to 5:45. Then a closing circle and socialize until 6.

Description of the Dances: The dances are 80-90 minutes of unstructured free form dance from DJ music. We have chairs set out and there is no need for any physical abilities, sit and wiggle a finger, and we hope to get some of the greyheads, like myself, out there. People may dance in any combination or solo. There are no rules or steps. We do not converse during the dance. I think of it as silent worship to music with the same goals of finding meaning and spiritual awareness, but some just enjoy the activity, socialization and exercise, and that is fine.

These types of dances occur internationally. They were largely inspired by the late Gabrielle Roth and her 5 Rhythms concept and each set weaver may utilize some of that.

Richard has been teaching 5 Rhythms for decades in the US and UK and if you are interested in that aspect, you are encouraged to talk with him or check it out at (<https://www.5rhythms.com/>)

My (Jack) take is that we seek to create a deep experience, spiritual for many, but others may just enjoy the movement, freedom, and exercise.

We hope to see you, any questions call Jack 919-245-8393 jackhwolf49@gmail.com

Report from the James Cates Scholars Program, Sat. Aug. 8, 5 pm

John Bell shares with Friends:

Friends will recall Danita Mason-Hogans spoke to our meeting some months previous, about the organization she founded: [Bridging the Gap](#). A number of individuals and the meeting itself have supported its innovative work.

This educational program is directed specifically to Black middle and high school students from Chapel Hill and Carrboro, to discover local, regional and national civil rights history via personal interviews with their elders and others.

This summer's James Cates Scholars program has recently returned from a civil rights tour of the Deep South and will be presenting its findings Saturday August 8 at the Chapel Hill Public Library 5:00-7:00pm. Refreshments will be served. All are welcomed and encouraged to spread the word. There is no charge.

For more info email Johnbellinc@gmail.com

Invitation to a Really Silent Meeting in Minneapolis, Sept. 16-20

Sam Leeman-Munk shares with Friends:

On Thursday, September 17th at 11:00 AM, I've arranged an hour of worship inside the anechoic chamber at Orfield Laboratories in Minneapolis — the quietest room in North America, so quiet you can hear your own heartbeat. A room like that ought to hold a meeting for worship at least once, and now it will: a really silent meeting.

For Friends traveling with me, the shape of the trip is a short retreat:

- **Wednesday, Sept 16** — Fly into Minneapolis. Easy afternoon; I'm planning a walk to Minnehaha Falls, a 53-foot waterfall inside the city.
- **Thursday, Sept 17** — Worship in the chamber at 11:00, then lunch together at Matt's Bar, home of a Minneapolis institution called the Jucy Lucy (ask me).
- **Friday, Sept 18** — A day trip to Lake Superior's North Shore: Gooseberry Falls, Split Rock Lighthouse, and the closest thing the Midwest has to an ocean. Friends could fly home Friday night or Saturday.
- **Sunday, Sept 20** (optional extension) — I'll be worshipping with Minneapolis Friends Meeting at 10:00 AM and would love company; note that Saturday I'm at the wedding that occasioned this trip, so Friends staying through the weekend would have that day to themselves.

What I'm providing: the chamber session and the driving — airport runs, the waterfall, the North Shore, and Sunday's meeting for those who stay.

What travelers would cover: flights to MSP, lodging, and meals. I'm staying at the Country Inn & Suites in Brooklyn Center; you're welcome to book there too or stay wherever suits you.

The chamber holds six worshippers, and four spots remain — so if you're interested, even tentatively, **please reply by August 2nd**, and I'll hold seats in the order Friends write.

And come for whatever calls to you — the chamber, the lake, or both. Every piece of this trip is optional; the silence at the center of it is merely the occasion.

In peace,
Sam Leeman-Munk



Quakers in the World

Celia Petrie Performs as Alice, Fri. Aug. 7 and Sat. Aug. 8

Mansir Petrie shares with Friends:

Celia is playing the lead role in her production of [Alice by Heart!](#)

Here are the performance dates:

- **Friday, August 7th** at 6pm
- **Saturday, August 8th** at 2pm and 6pm

Here's how you can get tickets. [You can book your tickets here.](#) Feel free to spread the word to anyone else who might like it!

Vault Theatre

4221 Garrett Rd. Unit 3
Durham, NC 27707

Just a heads-up, the performance space is cozy and has limited seating, so please book early to make sure you get a ticket for your favorite performance time.

Big hugs,
Mansir



Announcements

Report from Quaker House

Curt Torrell shares with Friends:

At the May Quaker House board meeting, GI Rights Counselor Steve Woolford shared that we are in a moment of an active war that is not supported by many people in the military. Distrust of policy is increasing and began prior to the escalation in Iraq with the warfare underway earlier in

Gaza. The sending of National Guard members into U.S. cities also raised many questions. People in the defense community are not supportive of engagement with Iran, and there is a distrust of the government. Current members of the military are challenged to find how recent actions fit with what they signed up to do. These actions do not feel justified or actions of defense. Traditional calls continue but are now joined by increasing calls asking about illegal orders and also inquiring about conscientious objection. The increase of calls [from ~200/month to ~400/month] from people who are questioning their role in the current military are from those who do not have a vocabulary of non-violence and often coming from a military family background so it is a different process from working with those who had an earlier framework to build upon. This is a meaningful moment that resonates with the founding needs for Quaker House that demonstrates the vital importance of Quaker House.

Fallout from ICE raids in Minneapolis

DACA people who couldn't work for many months

Wendy Michener shares with Friends:

The 19th has been following what happened after the national attention faded, and their [latest story](#) checks in on Bri (a stunning community worker) who has launched a new [Go Fund Me](#) to raise money to help community DACA recipients with the legal fees to renew their status (every two years - \$1500). The article is really worth a read, and if anyone can give to Bri's [Go Fund Me](#) this is such a worthy cause!

Quaker Walk

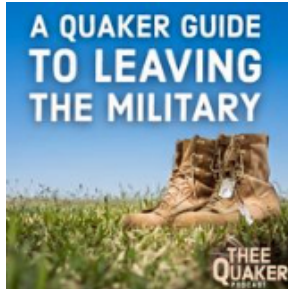
On Thursday, August 6th, the Friends Incubator for Public Ministry is holding a conversation about the [National Peace Walk 2026](#), which is currently bound for Minneapolis. We passed through many meetings in PFYMF in July, including Raleigh, Durham, New Garden, Friendship, Winston-Salem, and Swannanoa Valley ([see our instagram post](#)). We are resting in Asheville, currently bound for Minneapolis this fall.

The Friends Incubator for Public Ministry is holding a conversation with ross brubeck, public minister and pilgrim who has been traveling by foot to visit Quaker meetings throughout the country. ross' journey began this past May after organizing with New York Quakers in order to continue the project of intervisitation which began with last year's Walk to Washington. The conversation will touch on the challenge of sustaining a vocation of peacework during a time of societal change and distraction, and how faith is applied when walking in solitude and isolation between meetings of Friends.

<https://www.friendsincubator.org/event-details/the-loneliness-of-the-pilgrim-a-public-ministers-testimony-from-the-national-peace-walk>

THEE QUAKER Podcast

Wendy Michener shares the following from THEE QUAKER:



An active-duty soldier experiences a sudden moral awakening that leaves him trapped inside the military machine he can no longer answer to. We go inside the barracks to discover the Quakers who are helping him get out. Through the GI Rights Hotline, counseling services, and peace advocacy, Quaker House has been quietly providing a vital lifeline to people in uniform for almost 60 years.

Discover how this place of peace has operated so effectively in a city of war, and how we can all become more effective peacemakers. [Click here to listen!](#)

Box Fans and Cooling Centers Available

Alice Carlton shares with Friends:

Orange Co. has box fans to give out to those who need them. They have also opened cooling centers at the Main Library in Hillsborough and at the Drakeford Library in Carrboro. Contact Wil Glenn, Community Relations Director: wglenn@orangecountync.gov for more information.



Personals

Home for Sale

Allie Scales shares with Friends:

My much loved home in the Kirkwood community is for sale. Two bed, three bathrooms, and lots of bonuses, not least, glorious sunsets, and neighbor to Matt and Lynn Drake! Easy reach of CHFM, and lots of neighborhood amenities.

https://www.zillow.com/homedetails/104-Homewood-Dr-Chapel-Hill-NC-27514/50051796_zpid/





Recurring Announcements

InterFath Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Carolyn White.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions:

zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).



Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm

You are invited to join Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine and Israel at 5:30 p.m. ET / 2:30 p.m. PT.

Join on Zoom:

<https://afsc-org.zoom.us/j/85831333364?pwd=VEtPTUZuYk5hTHV2OGs1VzRkY0ZKUT09>

Meeting ID: 858 3133 3364

Passcode: 759311

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. "A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom."

<https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779>

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence "You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below."

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09>

Meeting ID: 416 500 5614

Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.



Business Meeting Minutes

As usual, there was no business meeting in July.

Chapel Hill Monthly Meeting of the Religious Society of Friends

531 Raleigh Road, Chapel Hill, NC 27514

Resident: John Hite (919) 929-5377